KUNSANG GAR WISDOM PROGRAM

Geshe Dangsong Namgyal
Dzogchen Meditation
Tibetan Buddhist Rimé Tradition



THE MEANING OF KUNSANG GAR

One essential meaning of Kunsang Gar is “Pure Natural Mind.” The other meaning is accepting all traditions as unified. It comes from Kunsang (Tibetan), meaning ever excellent, all-good, and complete, and Gar, meaning place.

PROGRAM





Bön teachings help us develop a better understanding of our true nature by studying the ancient wisdom teachings and integrating them into our spiritual practice. Our mental difficulties and painful feelings arise, but are temporary. They are dependent upon causes and conditions which do not exist in our original nature. Geshe has distilled from Bon and Buddhist traditions' methods for dispelling problems into the Kunsang Gar Wisdom Program in three categories: Foundational Wisdom, Mental Development and Quintessential Wisdom.



SOURCE OF TEACHINGS

Kunsang Gar teachings originate from the Nine Vehicles of Bön Zhang Zhung, taught by founder Tonpa Shenrab Miwoche. Additional core teachings are from the teachings of Buddhism's founder Shakyamuni Buddha, and its scriptural tradition of commentaries by the masters of Nalanda Monastery that spread throughout Tibet.

FOUNDATIONAL WISDOM

Fundamental Bön teachings address a detailed cosmological understanding, along with healing practices to create well-being and harmony in the relative world.





UNDERSTANDING UNIVERSE AND INFINITE ENERGY

1. The connection between elements and spirits
2. Recognition of deities and demons
3. Effects of karma and reincarnation
4. Meaning of life and soul
5. Liberation from samsara
6. Establishing proper devotion and motivation
7. Purification through preliminary practice [ngondro]

These teachings address concepts such as compassion, karma, samsara and nirvana, our interdependent nature, the nature of our mental and physical bodies, the view of reincarnation, relative and ultimate truths, what causes suffering and how to liberate it.



MENTAL DEVELOPMENT

CHANGING THE MIND

Mental development includes teachings that uncover the essential view that everything lacks a self-existent nature. By freeing ourselves from extremes and clearing our obscurations through the teachings, we can clarify the nature of emptiness (śūnyatā) in all phenomena, enabling us to create a source of confidence in the potential for realizing Buddhahood within ourselves. These programs include teachings on transforming one's mind from that of an ordinary person into one that is calm, compassionate, altruistic, content, harmonious, and courageous.

Topics describe concepts such as:

1. Loving kindness and compassion
2. Mindfulness
3. Calm abiding and special insight
4. Emptiness and bodhichitta
5. Mind training
6. Buddhist psychology
7. Ten perfections
8. Yogas of Body, mind, deity, dream, and death.
9. Holy mantras
10. Intention and dedication of Ceremony and rituals



Included here are meditative practices such as śamatha (calm abiding) and vipaśyanā (insight). Methods for working with energy such as yogas of the body and breath, dream yoga and training for death can develop deeper, more liberating experiences.





In addition, deity yoga and mantra or connecting with enlightened beings, Buddhas and Bodhisattvas and their maṇḍalas, can provide protection, temporary and ultimate, creating unbreakable happiness even through emotional experience.

NATURAL MIND MEDITATION IN DZOGCHEN: QUINTESSENTIAL WISDOM

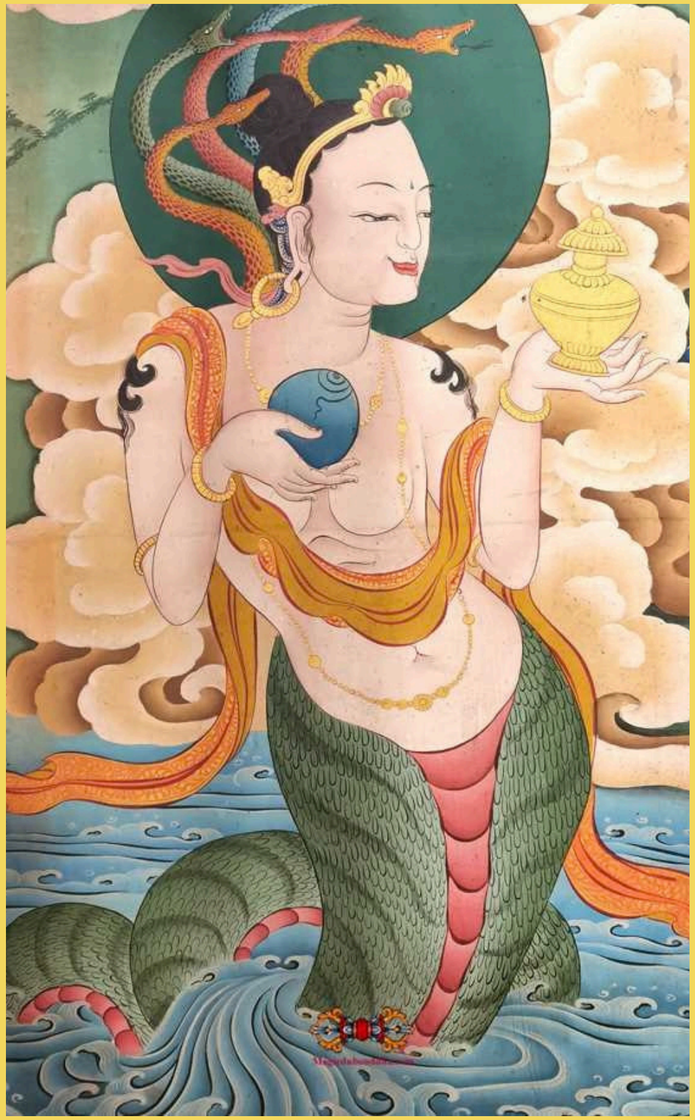


The main practice at Kunsang Gar is Pure Dzogchen (rdogs: perfection, chen: great) or meditation on the Natural Mind. We turn our awareness inward to find profound happiness, prepare ourselves for dying, and ultimately, transform ignorance on this path of enlightenment.

Pure Dzogchen, not influenced by sutra and tantra, naturally reveals the spontaneous qualities of luminosity and clarity within us. Those with busy lives can greatly benefit by integrating Dzogchen into their practice. Obscured through ignorance, this practice enables one to see and experience the recognition of the Natural State.

Dzogchen instructions were historically kept very secret in the ancient era and given only to students with a strong foundation and spiritual development. In the Kunsang Gar program, Geshe weaves teachings from the foundational and mental development categories to bring simultaneous development and more complete
understanding with the dzogchen teachings. Geshe brings these teachings now in order to address modern, degenerate problems and quickly create great benefit.

Teachings include:
1. Special Dzogchen Ngondro (Rushan)
2. Mind recognition
3. Natural Mind
4. Luminosity on Dzogchen
5. Mantra of Dzogchen
6. Purification in Dzogchen
7. Spiritual songs



THE HEALING CULTURE OF BÖN

Bön is the indigenous spiritual culture of Zhang Zhung, the area surrounding Mount Kailash in present day Tibet. Within it is a rich history of tantra, shamanism and meditation, with evidence dating back 4,000 years, and an oral history of 18,000 years.
Through many centuries, Tibetan and Himalayan people have developed powerful and effective practices and rituals to allay the effects of living in a harsh environment. Meditators of great ability received teachings and transmissions for healing temporary as well as ultimate imbalances. Many of these ancient wisdom practices survive today, and like those of other native cultures, can benefit us greatly.

Bön holds a deep reverence and oneness with nature. When we balance the elements and care for the land, we live in harmony with the earth and spirits.



There are two primary types of ritual: one is the extensive practice and accomplishment (sādhana) of secret tantra, and its far-reaching activities. The second type involves many methods, such as divination, medicines, and rituals to harmonize and protect beings and the environment.

These include:

- Phya shen: ex., divination, astrology, spirit harmony, medicine, etc
- Nang Gshen: ex., mountain ritual, environmental deity, offering to lu /soul retreival
- Phrul Gshen: ex., wrathful rituals with negative spirits
- Srid Gshen: ex., spirit protection

For example, in the Nāga Sūtra (Lubum), ancient Tibetan culture teaches us how serve human society through protecting and preserving the natural elements and natural resources well, and by reducing environmental pollution.

SUPPORTIVE TEACHINGS

- Sutra (teachings of ancient Bön and Buddhism)
- Healing Ritual
- Buddhist Psychology / Mind Science
- Loving Kindness and Compassion
- Ba sic and Advanced Mindfulness
- Mind Training
- Six Yogas /Tsa Lung
- Tibetan Culture and Exchange with Indigenous peoples
- Liaison with community resource groups and community projects

GESHE DANGSONG NAMGYAL

Kunsang Gar's Spiritual Director, Geshe Dangsong Namgyal, is a Buddhist teacher, scholar, author, and meditation master. As a Rimé teacher, he embraces all the traditions and schools of Bön and Tibetan Buddhism.

Born in the Kham region of Tibet, he received basic Bön spiritual culture, early preliminary, tantra, ritual and dzogchen training from his father, uncles, Dzogchen yogi Uri Lama Tsultrim Gyaltsen, Togdhen Sherab, and Togdhen Sherab Phuntsok. At the age of fifteen, he entered Lungkar Monastery where he studied meditation (drub dra) from Khenpo Nyima Lodo and Lopon Tsultrim Namdag.





In 1991, crossed the Himalayan Mountains to continue his studies at the shedra in Menri Monastery in India. In 1995, Geshe attended Sera Jey Monastery in South India and received teachings from many great masters. He completed a ten year course in Buddhist Logic and Epistemology, Madhyamaka, sutra yana (Prajnaparamita) stages of the path to the state of Buddhahood.

In 2005, he attended the Bön monastery Triten Norbutse in Nepal, studying with Lopon Tenzin Namdag. His studies included Bön philosophy, Madhyamaka, Prajnaparamita, Vinaya, Abhidharma, secret Tantra, and Dzogchen. In 2011, he received the degree of Geshe.

He has presented at numerous global conferences and has written more than 20 books in Tibetan and English. His first English book “Pure Dzogchen” is liked by many people and has been translated into several languages.

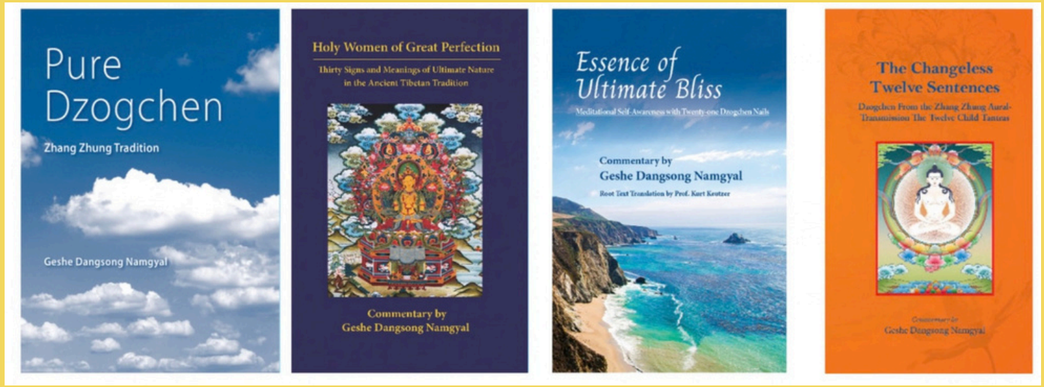
Geshe arrived in California, ˙US in 2013, and has been continuously providing non-sectarian Tibetan spiritual and cultural teachings to those interested in the West. Since the Kunzang Gar nonprofit was established in 2016 in California, Geshe has expanded teachings in the United States, Europe, Latin American, and Asia.

SERVICES

House and Business Blessing
Spiritual Consultation
Ceremony and Prayers for the Living
Guidance through Death & Dying: Phowa



PUBLICATIONS



All of Geshe's publications—in many languages—are now available to order online in the United States, Europe and Australia directly and on-demand.
For more information and for direct links, visit:
https://www.kunsanggarcenter.org/publications

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